

MAN OF LEARNING

Zhang Heng's work on mechanical devices was much admired by many Chinese scholars and inventors who followed him in later centuries. Zhang was also highly thought of for his astronomical studies and observations. He made a catalog of 2,500 stars and more than 120 constellations. Zhang is pictured here with his earthquake indicator.



120 CE

He publishes *The Spiritual Constitution of the Universe*. This includes his theory that Earth is at the center of the Universe.

125 CE

He describes his armillary sphere and helps to make a mechanical cart with an odometer, an instrument for calculating distances traveled.

132 CE

Zhang Heng introduces one of his most famous inventions to the imperial court: the earthquake indicator.

138 CE

He retires from official duties and returns home to Nanyang for a short time. Zhang Heng is recalled by the Emperor to the capital, where he dies in 139 CE.